

The Heart Knot

Tuesday, 29 September 2026 · plot: what changed, what is canon, promises, threads, quotes

Plot: what changed in the world, what is now canon, what was promised, what is left hanging. This was the last session — so this is also the campaign's end state.

Act on this first: the campaign is complete. The party **freed the Dreamer**; the four hearts are gone with her, **Midnight is buried** on the Wyrnwood lakeshore, **Thomas has his name back**, and you narrated each character's epilogue at the table. The plot doc and world-state want a final "how it ended" entry; everything below is the raw material for it.

1 · What changed

- **The Dreamer is free.** Four hearts into the heart knot, one per round — Duskheart (Jetten), Graveheart (Morgash), Tideheart (Gren), Thornheart (Invictus). On the fourth the knot opened, she stepped out with the whole heart, it turned to flesh, she took it back, the tree went into full bloom, and she was gone. Her last words, fading: *"Thank you. Thank you so much. I can never repay you."* No reward, no bargain — she left.
- **Invictus refused Shar.** The Duskheart possessed Jetten and read Shar's last offer. The party argued him out of it; he prayed to Lathander on the lakeshore at dawn; **the Dawnfather appeared in the fog**: *"You are not completely lost, my child, but the sword you wield must be left here. Bury it. First Light is gone."* Midnight is buried; the sword calls to him from the ground, "screaming". After the passing he said **"Thomas. My name is Thomas."** — Shar's price undone.
- **Pudgy lives.** Raised by the Thornheart before the long rest (its one and only use). Honeysuckle and Pinenut are buried under an acorn tree near the drowned temple. Pudgy is Gren's companion for good.
- **Greenrest.** The whole town shared the fourth dream — clear this time, no mist. Oswin begged the party in the road, then **Pip** turned him (*"They need to do what they need to do"*) and he said he'd stand the guards down — but three mobs came anyway. After the passing: the mist rolls back in; commoners won't speak to them; the elders understand and cannot forgive; Oswin: *"Please, please just go."*

- **Chauntea answers.** In the epilogue, Enid's prayer at a sick child's bedside is answered for the first time in Greenrest's history — the Earthmother has forgiven the town. Harvests smaller but real; a healer of their own. (The plot doc's §3.4 silence is ended.)

2 • Now canon — said out loud, on tape

- **Shar's offer, as read:** Midnight into the heart knot drains the tree **and the shards**; each shard is a resurrection and "the heart of the tree" a fifth; the shards die, Midnight holds the five. *"I will win. My will shall be done. Think carefully, Invictus. This is my last offer."* It was refused — it was her last offer.
- **The Dreamer's plea** (dream 4): she forgives Corin (*"he was right"*) and herself; *"Bring the hearts to my tree. Find the heart knot. Place them in it, one by one, and I will absorb them. On the fourth, I shall be free."* She looked at Invictus as she faded and smiled a little.
- **The heart rule** you ruled: one at a time; a full turn of concentration at the knot; interrupted means start over; absorbed at the placer's next turn.
- **The passing:** *"It's stone. It has been stone in your hands for so long, warm and hard, and now it beats inside of me again."* — the LINE, delivered.
- **Epilogue fates (your narration):**
 - **Morgash** — retires on the gems; accepts Warin's offer to hold the gate at Hedgewatch; stays because he "feels responsible"; forgiven in time; free breakfast and dinner from Oswin forever; a permanent room at the Full Larder.
 - **Jetten** — the moonstone glows green one last time; a real dream of his sister sent by the Dreamer; he says goodbye; the stone is milky white. Keeps wandering; stays Thomas's friend.
 - **Thomas** — a month later in Daggerford: reconciles with the temple of Lathander, visits the five graves, reads every name aloud and then his own, stays until dark; the grief ends. A paladin again; goes adventuring with Jetten for a few years (*"Fafhrd and the Grey Mouser"*).
 - **Gren** — Gren the Mighty who freed the Green Lady; the warren sends for him; a feast. Plants the Everseed Acorn in the square beside the old tree; stays in Greenrest; the squirrel cult, Pudgy as prophet; the oak drops its leaves every autumn.
 - **The Three Amigos** — Gren, Morgash and Pudgy. Gren's old debt to Morgash is paid in acorns at the bedside every morning; Morgash steps on them half the time.
 - **Greenrest** — leaves fall in the square for the first time; Oswin on the Mayor's Tower steps; a few families go south for the winter.

3 • Promises and their status

WHO	PROMISED	STATUS
Gren → Pudgy	Bury Honeysuckle and Pinenut outside	Kept — under the acorn tree
Pudgy → Invictus	Never reveal where Midnight is buried	Kept (<i>"What is? I don't know anything."</i>)
Pudgy	Tell the forest their deeds, then come to town	Kept — arrived just after the passing
Oswin	Key to the city, a home, free meals — if they didn't do it	Withdrawn ; they did it
Oswin	Stand the guards down	Kept in word — the mobs came regardless
The Dreamer	"I can never repay you"	Left without a reward (see table feedback in the mechanics notes)
Warin → Morgash	Hold the gate at Hedgewatch	Accepted in the epilogue
Oswin → Morgash	Free breakfast and dinner, a room at the Full Larder	Epilogue canon

4 • Threads left in the ground (for any return to this world)

1. **Midnight**, buried on the Wyrnwood lakeshore, still calling. Only the party and Pudgy know where. Shar's order knows a Dark Justiciar walked out of their temple — and that he walked away from her.
2. **Shar** made her *last* offer and was refused. "Somebody is always above a high priest."
3. **The Iris** — never opened.
4. **The geased druid** — his fate was never narrated; with Bramblemaw dead, he is free and a witness.
5. **Tess in Daggerford** — Marn's letter was never delivered.
6. **The will-o'-wisp** that escaped in the Misty Forest.
7. **Lae'zel** — Anthony said out of the moment that Morgash would "try to find Lae'zel and live my life," then chose Hedgewatch when you offered it. The Lae'zel door is still open.
8. **The stash**: Staff of Withering, Decanter of Endless Water, Driftglobe, the Rival Coin (Tiamat side up), ~10,700 gp in gems (Morgash's retirement).

5 · Loot with story weight

- **The four hearts** — gone into the Dreamer.
- **Midnight** — buried. **A plain Scimitar** (Jetten's, via the stash) now hangs at Thomas's side.
- **The Everseed Acorn** — planted in the square; a young oak.
- **Jetten's moonstone** — milky white now; its green glow is finally explained.
- **Thomas's name** — returned.

6 · Quotes of the night

"What happened? Oh, my goodness. Oh. Did we kill the dragon? Did we beat him?"

— Pudgy, freshly raised.

"It sounds like a trap, Invictus. Like a bargain with the devil."

— Jetten, having just been made to offer it.

"It's not the same sword. Don't lie to yourself."

— Morgash.

"You lost your bearings when you killed that guy."

— Morgash.

"You haven't done anything wrong... you don't need redemption, but if you do this you will need redemption."

— Gren.

"I think that's what Shar does for her acolytes... Takes the pain away from you."

— Invictus.

"You are not completely lost, my child, but the sword you wield must be left here. Bury it. First Light is gone."

— Lathander, in the fog.

"What is? I don't know anything. Yes, sir."

— Pudgy.

"I think he's right, Mayor. They need to do what they need to do."

— Pip.

"Don't do this evil thing, townspeople. Stay back."

— Invictus, booming.

"This is for you, and blot out all my iniquities, Lathander."

— Invictus, leaning from the saddle with the Thornheart.

"Thank you. Thank you so much. I can never repay you." / "Yes, you can. Wait."

— the Dreamer; Morgash.

"Thomas. My name is Thomas."

— Thomas.

GM-only. Compiled from the transcript, the chat log and the live sheets by the session scribe.